

Le tigre

Le campagnard

Le parieur fou

Le cancre

INTRODUCTION

Hello everyone,

Today, Abel, Paul, Jeremy, and I are going to present Réunion Island and the data we studied during the holidays.

Our goal was to better understand how this territory works and what its main characteristics are.

To do this, we chose to analyze several key themes: population, employment, income, culture, education, and transport. These indicators allow us to understand both the strengths and the difficulties of Réunion Island.

So, here is our poster.

Réunion Island is a French overseas department and region, located in the Indian Ocean, about 9,000 kilometers from mainland France. Despite this long distance, Réunion is fully part of France and the European Union.

The island covers an area of 2,504 square kilometers and is divided into 24 municipalities. Its geographical isolation and mountainous relief strongly influence its economic development, transport, employment, and territorial organization. This remoteness creates specific challenges but also gives Réunion a unique identity.

POPULATION

Let's start with the population.

In 2022, the population of Réunion Island was estimated at about 881,938 inhabitants. Between 2016 and 2022, the population increased at an average rate of around 0.5% per year. This growth is mainly explained by a positive natural balance.

In fact, in 2022, there were 11,818 births compared to 5,832 deaths, which means that the number of births is much higher than the number of deaths. This situation contrasts with mainland France, where population growth is slower and sometimes decreasing.

Another important characteristic is that Réunion has a very young population. Around 32% of inhabitants are under 25 years old, which is significantly higher than in mainland France. This makes Réunion a young territory, full of potential.

However, this youth also represents a major challenge. A young population means that the region must create enough jobs, training opportunities, schools, and housing to

meet future needs. Without sufficient economic development, this demographic dynamism can become a source of social difficulties.

EMPLOYMENT

Now let's talk about employment.

Economically, Réunion Island is characterized by a strong predominance of the service sector. Around 80% of jobs are in services, especially in public administration, commerce, health, and education. This shows the importance of the public sector and public funding in the local economy.

Agriculture represents around 3% of total employment. It mainly focuses on sugar cane, which is a historical and strategic crop for the island.

Industry, on the other hand, accounts for about 7% of jobs, which is relatively low compared to mainland France.

This economic structure shows that Réunion's economy is not very diversified and remains highly dependent on services and public support, inherited from its colonial and administrative history.

One of the most serious issues is unemployment. In 2023, the unemployment rate was about 20% of the working population, compared to around 7% in mainland France. This means that unemployment is almost three times higher in Réunion.

The situation is even more worrying for young people aged 15 to 24, where the unemployment rate exceeds 35%. Many young people struggle to enter the labor market, which can lead to discouragement, poverty, and social exclusion.

Education level plays a decisive role. People without a diploma have an unemployment rate of over 30%, while for those with a higher education degree, it falls below 10%. This clearly shows the importance of education and qualifications for professional integration.

Overall, these figures show that Réunion faces structural difficulties in employment, especially for young and low-skilled people.

INCOME

Let's now focus on income and living conditions.

The median annual income in Réunion is around 17,070 euros per consumption unit, whereas it is over 23,000 euros in mainland France. This difference highlights a significant income gap between Réunion and the rest of France.

The poverty rate is particularly high: about 36% of the population lives below the poverty line. This means that more than one third of inhabitants face financial difficulties in their daily lives.

These figures reveal strong social and economic inequalities. Many households depend on social benefits, such as housing assistance or family allowances, to meet their basic needs.

As a result, public policies and social assistance play a central role in maintaining social cohesion and reducing inequality in the region. However, these measures alone are not enough without long-term economic development and job creation.

CULTURE

Culture is another essential aspect of Réunion Island.

Réunion is known for its exceptional cultural diversity, which comes from its history of migration. Over time, populations from Europe, Africa, Madagascar, India, and China settled on the island, creating a unique multicultural society.

This diversity can be seen in languages, especially Réunion Creole, but also in music, dance, cuisine, and religious traditions. Cultural events and festivals play an important role in social life and identity.

This cultural richness is also a major asset for tourism. Tourism represents about 7% of the local GDP and provides more than 10,000 direct and indirect jobs. It contributes to economic activity while promoting the island's image internationally.

Therefore, culture is not only an identity marker but also a lever for economic development.

EDUCATION – LES ÉTUDES

Now let's talk about education.

In Réunion, around 38% of people aged 25 to 64 have no diploma or only a middle school certificate. In contrast, only 19% of people in this age group hold a higher education degree.

These figures are below the national average and help explain the employment difficulties observed on the island. A low level of education limits access to stable and well-paid jobs.

As we mentioned earlier, people without qualifications are much more exposed to long-term unemployment, while graduates have better professional opportunities.

This shows that education and vocational training are major strategic challenges for Réunion's future. Improving access to education is essential to reduce unemployment, poverty, and inequality, and to support economic development.

TRANSPORT

Finally, let's look at transport and mobility.

Due to its mountainous terrain and island location, transport in Réunion is mainly concentrated along the coastal road network. This limits mobility options, especially in the interior of the island.

More than 80% of daily trips are made by car, which leads to traffic congestion, pollution, and urban planning problems, particularly during peak hours.

Developing public transport infrastructure is therefore a major challenge for the region. Better transport solutions are essential for economic efficiency, social equality, and environmental protection.

Transport data is also crucial for land use planning, ecological transition, and sustainable development projects.

CONCLUSION

To conclude, the data we studied help us better understand how Réunion Island functions as a territory.

They highlight important difficulties, such as high unemployment, poverty, educational gaps, and transport constraints. However, they also show strong potential, especially thanks to a young population, cultural diversity, and strategic sectors like tourism and services.

Réunion faces major challenges, but with appropriate public policies, investment in education, and sustainable development, the island has real opportunities for the future.

Thank you for your attention